Admissions team pack: running an assessment visit

This is the simple pack for the admissions team and the assessors. It says what to print, what happens when, who does what, and where every mark goes. The full guide (`00_Admissions_Guide`) and the evidence documents (`01` to `03`) stay as the background; you do not need them on the day.

1. The visit in one page

Three kinds of paper, so that nothing is printed twice.

Kind	What it is	When you print it
Print once (kept in a folder, laminated where marked)	The **assessor instructions** for the year group; the **interviewer guide** for the phase; `Sentence_Reading_Guide`; the reading cards (laminate); the Early Reading Screen guide and cards (Years 1 to 3); the **listening recording** (a sound file, nothing to print)	Once for the room, then reuse. No student name; nobody writes on them
Print for each candidate (the candidate pack, `pdf/Candidate_Packs/`)	The **student paper** (or booklet); the **grading sheet**; the **Reading front sheet**; the **Interview sheet**; the **parent conversation record**; the **final mark sheet**. Years 1 to 3 also have the Early Reading Screen record sheets	One pack per candidate, double-sided
Sent beforehand	The previous homeroom teacher reference (English and Chinese)	When the family has given consent

Who does what.

Role	Does
Admissions officer	Collects documents and consent, books the visit and the interview slot, prints the candidate pack, welcomes the family, hands the interviewer the sheets, files everything, enters the results, communicates the decision
Assessor (a teacher)	Runs the written and spoken tasks (Section 3), marks the paper, completes the **grading sheet**, fills in Part 1 of the **Reading front sheet** and hands it over
Interviewer (usually the principal; the homeroom teacher or the assessor in Years 1 to 3)	Runs the sentence reading (Years 4 to 10) and the interview, completes the **Reading front sheet** (Parts 2 and 3) and the **Interview sheet**
Head of section	Reads the final mark sheet and confirms the recommendation. The Designated Safeguarding Lead gets anything worrying the same day

The visit, step by step.

Step	Who	What	Paper
1	Admissions	Family arrives. Welcome, show where parents wait. Parent conversation starts with another member of staff (about 15 minutes)	Parent conversation record
2	Assessor	Runs the sections in Section 3 (the day sheet for the year group)	Student paper, grading sheet
3	Assessor	Marks the paper, fills in the grading sheet and Part 1 of the Reading front sheet	Grading sheet, Reading front sheet
4	Admissions	Gives the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet (Section 5)	
5	Interviewer	Sentence reading and interview, then completes both sheets and returns them	Reading front sheet, Interview sheet
6	Admissions, head of section	Thanks the family: **no results are given on the day**. Final mark sheet within two working days (Section 6)	Final mark sheet

2. Before the visit

A week before

- ☐ Application, passport or ID page, school reports for the last two years and signed consent are in. Homeroom teacher reference sent.
- ☐ Visit booked (mornings are best for young children). Family told how long it takes, to bring glasses or hearing aids, and asked about access needs.
- ☐ Assessor, interviewer (check the principal's diary) and a second adult for young children are booked.

The day before

- ☐ Candidate pack printed double-sided (`pdf/Candidate_Packs/Year_NN_Candidate_Pack_v3.1.pdf`; the table in Section 8 says what is in it). Years 1 to 3: print only the Early Reading Screen passage sheets you expect to use.
- ☐ Room set up: quiet and bright; a low table for Years 1 to 3; a clock; pencils, rubbers, a ruler from Year 3; counters (Years 1 and 2); crayons (Years 1 and 2) or coloured pencils (Year 3); a calculator for each student in Year 9 and 10 maths Section C.
- ☐ The assessor's folder is in the room: the assessor instructions, the sentence reading guide and card, and for Years 1 to 3 the Early Reading Screen guide, cards and levelled books.
- ☐ **Listening recording** copied to the laptop or phone and the speaker tested (Section 4).

On the day

- ☐ Candidate number written on every sheet of the pack (the student paper carries the name).
- ☐ Door open or a second adult in the room for young children. Anything worrying goes to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

3. Day sheets

Each sheet is the timetable for one phase. Each step has a section in the **assessor instructions** for the year group: the exact words to say, the answers and the marks are there. **Pace of speech:** speak slowly and clearly, in short phrases, with the youngest (Years 1 to 3) and steadily and clearly with the older students, with a pause after each sentence that is longer the younger the student (the recordings are paced this way). Use the same pace for every candidate in a year group.

Years 1 to 3 (about 46 to 54 minutes, 1:1, play-based)

Step	Minutes Y1 / Y2 / Y3	Section	The child	You	Record on
1	1 / 1 / 2	Welcome	Says their name and age	Smile; sit beside the child; write the name on the booklet cover; show where the parent waits	
2	4 / 4 / 4	Picture talk	Looks at the picture, answers the prompts	Give the prompts in order, wait about 5 seconds, write down the child's own words. Stop after three prompts with no answer	Grading sheet, Section 1
3	5 / 5 / 4	Listening game	Points, draws, colours	**Play the recording.** Watch the child, not the picture. Mark each item 1 or 0 as you go. If asked, go back and play the item once more (tick R). Stop after three 0s in a row	Grading sheet, Section 2
4	12 / 12 / 12	Reading: Early Reading Screen, then sentence reading	Reads letter sounds, words and short stories aloud, then sentences	Start at the point for the year (Early Reading Screen guide). Then sentence reading from Level 1 (Years 1 and 2) or Level 2 (Year 3) with `Sentence_Reading_Guide`	Early Reading Screen record (Sheet 13); Reading front sheet, Part 2
5	2 / 2 / 3 to 5	Movement break	Stretches, has water	Do the actions with the child	
6	12 / 15 / 18	Maths	Counts, points, shows with counters, writes	Read every question as written; repeat or show with counters if asked. Write 1 or 0 in the mark box on the child's page; write NT or L beside it	Mark boxes in the booklet; grading sheet
7	5 / 6 / 8	Writing	Writes their name, dictated words, a sentence or a picture story (by year)	Dictate clearly at the year's pace. Do not spell or write for the child	Grading sheet
8	6 / 6 / 8	Play-based interview and goodbye	Draws and talks	Interviewer (often you): `Interviewer_Guide_Y1_Y2` or `_Y3_Y4`. Do not give results. Say something specific that went well	Interview sheet
	About 46 / 51 / 54				Then: grading sheet, Reading front sheet Part 1 and 3, final mark sheet

Years 1 to 3: the assessor runs the sentence reading as well as the Early Reading Screen, so the Reading front sheet stays with the assessor and Parts 1 to 3 are completed together; the interviewer only needs the Interview sheet. Year 2: listening, maths and writing may be done with two children together (assessor instructions, Section 1).

Years 4 to 6 (about 59 minutes in Year 4, 66 in Year 5 and 67 in Year 6)

Step	Minutes	Section	The student	You	Record on
1	2	Welcome	Listens	Say the welcome script (instructions, Section 2)	
2	7 / 6 / 7 (recording)	Listening	Answers on pages 2 and 3	**Play the recording** (do not pause it). It reads the questions, plays the script twice and gives one minute to finish. Years 4 to 6 can be done in a small group	Student paper mark boxes
3	12	Reading paper (Parts A, B, C)	Works alone	Time it; two-minute warning; do not read the texts or explain words	Student paper; Reading front sheet, Part 1
4	10	Writing	Works alone	Time it; do not explain the prompts	Grading sheet
5	3 to 5	Break		Water, a chance to move	
6	18	Maths	Works alone	May read any question aloud, as often as asked. A Chinese-speaking colleague may say it once (mark L). NT if not taught. No calculator	Student paper; grading sheet
7	8	Science (Years 5 and 6 only)	Works alone	As for maths	Student paper; grading sheet
8	12	Interview, opening with sentence reading (Level 3 in Year 4, Level 4 in Year 5, Level 5 in Year 6)	Reads, then talks	**Interviewer** (Section 5): `Interviewer_Guide_Y3_Y4` or `_Y5_Y6`	Reading front sheet, Parts 2 and 3; Interview sheet
	About 59 (Year 4), 66 (Year 5), 67 (Year 6)				

Years 7 to 10 (about 95 minutes)

Step	Minutes	Section	The student	You	Record on
1	2	Welcome	Listens	Say the welcome script (instructions, Section 2)	
2	14 / 15 / 15 / 16 (recording, Years 7 to 10)	Listening, Parts A and B	Reads the questions for a minute, then answers while listening	**Play the Full recording** (do not pause it). Use Part A and Part B as two tracks if you may stop after Part A (a student with 2 or fewer in Part A may leave out Part B: see the instructions, Section 2)	Student paper mark boxes
3	15	Reading paper (Parts A and B)	Works alone	Time it; two-minute warning; do not read the texts or explain words	Student paper; Reading front sheet, Part 1
4	10	Writing (one task of two)	Works alone	Time it	Grading sheet
5	5	Break			
6	25	Maths (A fluency, B word questions, C applied)	Works alone	May read any question aloud. NT and L as above. No calculator, except a scientific calculator in Section C in Years 9 and 10	Student paper; grading sheet
7	8	Science	Works alone	As for maths	Student paper; grading sheet
8	15	Interview, opening with sentence reading (Level 6 in Year 7, 7 in Year 8, 8 in Year 9, 9 in Year 10)	Reads, then talks	**Interviewer** (Section 5): `Interviewer_Guide_Y7_Y10`. Years 7 to 10 can sit the written parts in a small group with one invigilator; the interview is always 1:1	Reading front sheet, Parts 2 and 3; Interview sheet
	About 95 (allow 100)				

4. The listening recordings

Every year group has a recording made from the scripts, so that every candidate hears the same voices, pace and pauses. It replaces the assessor reading the script. Play it on a speaker (not headphones) in a quiet room. Do the volume check before the student arrives. The files are in `audio/v3.1/YNN/`; each folder has a `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` with the tracks and, for Years 1 to 3, the start time of every item.

Year	Play this	Length	Voice speed (words a minute)	Also
1	`Y01_Listening_Full_v3.1.mp3`	4:35	185	start time of every item in the read-me
2	`Y02_Listening_Full_v3.1.mp3`	4:40	185	start time of every item in the read-me
3	`Y03_Listening_Full_v3.1.mp3`	4:10	190	start time of every item in the read-me
4	`Y04_Listening_Full_v3.1.mp3`	6:41	165	
5	`Y05_Listening_Full_v3.1.mp3`	5:50	175	
6	`Y06_Listening_Full_v3.1.mp3`	7:02	170	
7	`Y07_Listening_Full_v3.1.mp3`	13:50	200	Part A and Part B as separate tracks (if you may stop after Part A)
8	`Y08_Listening_Full_v3.1.mp3`	14:53	180	Part A and Part B as separate tracks (if you may stop after Part A)
9	`Y09_Listening_Full_v3.1.mp3`	14:33	180	Part A and Part B as separate tracks (if you may stop after Part A)
10	`Y10_Listening_Full_v3.1.mp3`	15:59	185	Part A and Part B as separate tracks (if you may stop after Part A)

How to play it

1. Student paper (or booklet) open at the right page, pencil ready, grading sheet in front of you.
2. Press play. **Do not pause or repeat** any part of the listening, except for the repeat rule in Years 1 to 3 (go back to the start of that item, play it once, tick R).
3. Mark the paper after the recording. Years 1 to 3: mark each item 1 or 0 as you go.
4. If the recording cannot be played, read the script live from the assessor instructions, at the pace for the year group in Section 3. Never mix the two in one test.

The pauses are longer for younger students. The voice speed is the same within each phase (0.85 of the voice's normal speed in Years 1 to 3 and Year 10, 0.9 in Years 4 to 9). The pause after each sentence is about a second in Years 1 to 3, about three quarters of a second in Years 4 to 6 and about half a second in Years 7 to 10. The voices are offline text-to-speech in British English. In two-person scripts the speakers have different voices, so the recording does not say their names.

5. Handing over to the interviewer

The interviewer is usually the principal. When you book the interview, give the interviewer one **interview pack** for each candidate, **before** the interview starts:

Give	What it is
Reading front sheet (2 pages)	Part 1 is already filled in by the assessor: the reading levels so far (Early Reading Screen, or the reading paper marks), the reading band so far, and where the sentence reading starts. The interviewer fills in Parts 2 and 3
Interview sheet (2 pages)	Speaking and listening bands, key things the student said, the suitability ratings, follow-ups, the interviewer's comment

The interviewer's own folder, kept from one candidate to the next (nothing to print again): `Interviewer_Guide_...` for the phase (the questions and descriptors), `Sentence_Reading_Guide` (the rules, the sentences and the meaning questions) and the laminated sentence reading card.

How it goes. 1. The assessor completes Part 1 of the Reading front sheet and gives both sheets to the interviewer (write who gave it and when, in Part 1). 2. The interviewer starts the interview with the sentence reading, from the start level printed on the front sheet (Level 1 if the assessor ticked "new to English"). 3. The interviewer asks the questions from the guide, then completes the Interview sheet while the memory is fresh. 4. Both sheets come back to admissions the same day, with a word to the assessor about anything unexpected. 5. Admissions clips the two sheets to the grading sheet and the parent conversation record.

6. After the visit

The same day

- Assessor: mark the paper; grading sheet complete, signed; Reading front sheet Part 1 complete.
- Interviewer: Reading front sheet Parts 2 and 3, and the Interview sheet, complete.
- Any safeguarding concern: told to the Designated Safeguarding Lead.

Within two working days: the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`). Copy the scores from the grading sheet, the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet, give the overall English band, tick one recommendation, write the support plan, and add the comments and the feedback for the family. The head of section confirms it. Admissions tells the family (start with the child's strengths).

Entering it in the system. One entry for each candidate, in this order, from the final mark sheet:

Field	From
Candidate number, name, date of birth, year group applied for, paper version sat	Final mark sheet, top
Listening, speaking, reading, reading aloud (indicative), writing, overall English: a band A to E for each	Final mark sheet, Section 1
Sentence reading points out of 72, reading age	Reading front sheet, Part 3
Maths score, band 1 to 4, number problems and word problems sub-scores; science score and band (Years 5 to 10)	Grading sheet, final mark sheet Section 2
Suitability ratings (any 1 flagged), follow-ups	Interview sheet, final mark sheet Section 3
Recommendation, support plan, review date	Final mark sheet, Sections 4 and 5
Date told to the family	Final mark sheet, sign-off

Filing. Keep the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet, parent conversation record and the marked student paper together with the final mark sheet, securely, for the period the school's data policy sets. Papers are confidential: do not let families photograph them or take them home.

7. The rules on one page

Rule	English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	Maths and science
Reading aloud	Only what the script says. Do not read the reading texts, explain words or translate. An instruction may be repeated in English	Any question may be read aloud in English, as often as asked, and you may point to the picture
Chinese	Not used by staff	A Chinese-speaking colleague may say the question **once**. Mark **L**. The mark still counts

Rule	English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	Maths and science
Answers	In English only. An answer in Chinese scores 0	In English only: numbers, ticks, drawings and working count. A Chinese answer or explanation scores 0

Code	Meaning
NT	Not yet taught: the student says they have not learnt it. Scores 0; list the topics on the grading sheet
L	A Chinese-speaking colleague said a maths or science question once in Chinese
R	A listening instruction was repeated once (Years 1 to 3)

Always: the student may stop any section when they have done what they can. Never press a distressed child: break or stop, and write it on the grading sheet. Praise effort, never correctness. Give no results on the day. Use the same papers, timings and pace for every candidate in a year group.

If something goes wrong. The recording will not play: read the script live at the year's pace (Section 4). A student is silent: smile, wait, move on; pointing tasks still work. A student stops early: record where and why. A parent wants to stay with a young child: they may sit quietly at the back; note it. A sheet is lost: reprint it from the candidate pack PDF; the version is on every page.

8. What each candidate pack contains

Year	Student paper or booklet	Grading sheet	Reading front sheet	Interview sheet	Parent conversation	Final mark sheet	Candidate pack (pages)	Was (pages)	Once: assessor folder (pages)
1	14	2	2	2	3	3	**46***	62	32
2	13	2	2	2	3	3	**46***	62	32
3	11	2	2	2	3	3	**44***	56	30
4	20	1	2	2	3	3	**34**	48	20
5	21	2	2	2	3	3	**36**	52	22
6	21	2	2	2	3	3	**36**	52	22
7	20	2	2	2	3	3	**34**	52	24
8	20	2	2	2	3	3	**34**	52	26
9	21	2	2	2	3	3	**36**	54	24
10	21	2	2	2	3	3	**36**	58	28

* Years 1 to 3: includes the Early Reading Screen record (18 pages): print only the sheets you expect to use. Every part starts on a new sheet (a blank page is added after a part with an odd number of pages), so print the pack double-sided and separate the parts. The staff pages for each candidate (everything except the student paper and, in Years 1 to 3, the Early Reading Screen record) are now about 14 instead of about 32.